



INTERNATIONAL FORUM OF AFRICAN GASTRONOMY (FIGA BOTSWANA 2026)

November 11-14, 2026

Theme

**African Gastronomy: Driving Tourism, Culture, Food Security
and Economic Development**



SPONSORING DOSSIER

HEAD OFFICE

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Ref : BTO I/2/5/2

Date : 12th August 2026

To Whom It May Concern

Dear Sir/Madam,

**ENDORSEMENT OF THE FIRST INTERNATIONAL GASTRONOMY AND
CULINARY ARTS (FIGA) BOTSWANA 2026**

The above subject matter refers.

The Botswana Tourism Organisation (BTO) is pleased to endorse the **First International Gastronomy and Culinary Arts (FIGA) Botswana 2026**, an initiative that seeks to showcase Botswana's rich culinary heritage, promote gastronomy tourism, and create meaningful opportunities for local and international stakeholders within the food, hospitality, tourism, and creative industries.

BTO recognizes the important role that gastronomy plays in enhancing destination competitiveness and enriching visitor experiences. The FIGA Botswana 2026 event aligns with Botswana's tourism diversification agenda by promoting cultural exchange, innovation, entrepreneurship, skills development, and investment opportunities within the tourism value chain.

We believe that the event has the potential to contribute positively to destination marketing efforts, increase visitor arrivals, provide market access opportunities for local producers and chefs, and position Botswana as a premier gastronomy tourism destination on the African continent.

While BTO is unable to provide direct financial sponsorship towards the event due to budgetary constraints, we are willing to support the initiative through **in-kind assistance and publicity support**, subject to the Organisation's policies and procedures. Such support may include:

- Promotion of the event through BTO's available communication and marketing platforms.
- Sharing event information through BTO's digital channels and stakeholder networks.
- Technical guidance and collaboration on tourism-related aspects of the event where applicable.
- Facilitation of linkages with relevant tourism stakeholders and industry partners.

BTO wishes the organisers every success in the planning and implementation of FIGA Botswana 2026 and looks forward to exploring opportunities for collaboration that will contribute to the growth and promotion of Botswana's tourism sector

Yours Sincerely,

A handwritten signature in black ink, appearing to read 'Justice Ofentse', written over a horizontal line.

Justice Ofentse

ACTING CHIEF EXECUTIVE OFFICER

AFRICA GASTRONOMIQUE BOTSWANA (AFGAB)

Aware that cultural development is a cornerstone for building a flourishing, inclusive, and resilient society, driven by the values of solidarity, identity, and mutual aid, we recognize the essential role of culinary heritage in shaping collective memory and national pride. While global gastronomy continues to evolve and gain recognition, African cuisine remains underrepresented on the world stage, despite its diversity, depth, and ancestral richness.

Committed to reversing this trend and promoting the excellence of our culinary traditions, we, at Africa Gastronomique, are undertaking a bold initiative to elevate and professionalize African gastronomy particularly, Botswana cuisine through education, innovation, and cultural celebration.



1- WHO ARE WE?

We are Africa Gastronomique, a dynamic pan-African association of chefs, culinary professionals, and passionate advocates of African cuisine. United by a shared vision, our mission is to promote and elevate African gastronomy with a particular focus on showcasing the richness of Botswana culinary heritage while transforming the perception of the restaurant and hospitality industries across the continent.

Present in 26 African countries, our network is growing rapidly, bringing together diverse talents and traditions under one shared goal: to preserve, modernize, and celebrate the ancestral culinary arts of Africa.

We are deeply committed to safeguarding Africa's gastronomic culture while positioning it on the global stage. Through education, capacity-building, and cultural celebration, we empower chefs, culinary students, and food entrepreneurs via:

- Specialized training sessions and masterclasses
- Cultural festivals and gastronomy fairs
- Culinary competitions and international summits
- Awareness campaigns on food safety and traditional knowledge
- Research and documentation of indigenous food practices



2- BACKGROUND

Over the past decade, gastronomy has emerged as a powerful catalyst for tourism development, cultural preservation, economic diversification, and social inclusion across Africa and the world. Increasingly, governments, development agencies, tourism authorities, and private sector stakeholders are recognizing the value of food as a strategic asset capable of creating jobs, stimulating local economies, strengthening value chains, and promoting national identity on the global stage.

The International Forum of African Gastronomy (FIGA) has been at the forefront of advancing this agenda by creating platforms that celebrate Africa's rich culinary heritage while fostering innovation, professional development, and cross-border collaboration. Through a series of successful gastronomy and culinary development initiatives, FIGA and its partners have demonstrated the transformative power of gastronomy in driving sustainable development and strengthening cultural diplomacy.

The success of previous flagship events has provided a strong foundation for the continued growth of Africa's gastronomy movement. Internationally, the Boston Food Festival (August 2025) brought together culinary professionals, food entrepreneurs, tourism stakeholders, and cultural practitioners to showcase the role of gastronomy in economic development, destination marketing, and cultural exchange. The festival highlighted how food-centered experiences can enhance tourism competitiveness while creating opportunities for local businesses and producers.

Across Africa, the West Africa Food Festival (WAFFEST) has become a leading platform for culinary innovation, cultural celebration, and industry development. WAFFEST Ghana (2022 and 2023) successfully showcased indigenous cuisines, promoted local food products, and facilitated collaboration among chefs, hospitality professionals, and tourism stakeholders. Building on this momentum, WAFFEST Nigeria (2024) expanded regional participation and strengthened discussions around food entrepreneurship, culinary education, and agrifood value chains. Uganda (2025) further demonstrated the growing influence of gastronomy as a driver of tourism and economic opportunity by connecting chefs, farmers, food processors, investors, and policymakers.



The FIGA Showcases in Rwanda (2024) and Togo (2025), together with International Chefs Day 2025, strengthened Africa's gastronomy ecosystem by promoting culinary excellence, mentorship, youth development, networking, business growth, destination promotion, and cultural exchange. These initiatives showed how gastronomy can support tourism growth, international cooperation, investment attraction, and culinary heritage preservation.

Building on this momentum, FIGA Botswana 2026 will create opportunities for knowledge exchange, investment, tourism promotion, and cultural diplomacy, bringing together chefs, hospitality professionals, policymakers, investors, educators, producers, development partners, and cultural practitioners from Africa and beyond.

Hosted in Botswana, FIGA Botswana 2026 will position the country as a leading gastronomy and culinary tourism destination by showcasing its indigenous foods, culinary traditions, agricultural products, hospitality excellence, innovation, entrepreneurship, skills development, and regional collaboration.

Through conferences, masterclasses, competitions, exhibitions, B2B engagements, cultural showcases, and investment dialogues, the forum will support economic diversification, local enterprises, job creation, stronger food

3- OBJECTIVES

Botswana offers a unique platform for hosting the International Forum of African Gastronomy. Globally recognised for its political stability, conservation leadership, premium tourism offerings, and sound economic governance, Botswana is well positioned to become a leading destination for gastronomy and culinary tourism. The country is home to a rich and diverse culinary heritage rooted in indigenous ingredients, traditional food systems, and the cultural identities of its many communities. From premium Botswana beef and sorghum to wild foods, traditional beverages, and regional culinary traditions, Botswana possesses authentic food experiences capable of complementing its world-renowned wildlife and cultural tourism products.

FIGA Botswana 2026 will showcase gastronomy as an integral component of the visitor experience, contributing to destination diversification, increased visitor spending, rural enterprise development, and the promotion of Botswana's cultural identity. The forum aligns with Botswana's national priorities of economic diversification, tourism development, citizen economic empowerment, youth employment, and the growth of the creative and hospitality industries.

To celebrate African gastronomy while building partnerships for sustainable growth, cultural preservation, and shared prosperity.

Specific Objectives

FIGA Botswana 2026 contributes directly to Botswana's strategic development priorities by:

- Promoting economic diversification through tourism, gastronomy and the creative economy.
- Supporting citizen economic empowerment through SME participation and entrepreneurship.
- Creating employment and skills development opportunities for young people.
- Promoting local procurement and value addition within the agrifood sector.
- Positioning Botswana as a preferred destination for Meetings, Incentives, Conferences and Exhibitions (MICE).
- Strengthening regional integration and intra-African trade under the African Continental Free Trade Area (AfCFTA).

- Advancing sustainable food systems through the promotion of indigenous foods and responsible sourcing

Through these interventions, FIGA Botswana 2026 contributes to inclusive economic growth while celebrating Botswana's cultural identity and strengthening its competitiveness within Africa's tourism and hospitality sectors.



4- Target participation

Category	Target
International Chefs & Experts	50
Botswana Chefs & Culinary Professionals	200
Hospitality Students	200
Exhibitors	30
Hoteliers	30
Tourism & Hospitality Businesses	30
Government & Development Partners	100
Media Representatives	10
Embassies	25
General Public (Festival Activities)	200
Gala Dinner Guests	300

Total Total Direct Participants Approximately 1000 Participants

Countries Targeted 20 African Countries

5- Key activities

DAY 1: OPENING CEREMONY & INDUSTRY ENGAGEMENT

08:00 – 10:00 | Official Opening Ceremony
10:00 – 10:30 | Botswana Indigenous Cuisine Challenge Tour
10:30 – 11:30 | Tasting Session
11:30 – 13:00 | Business-to-Business (B2B) Networking Sessions Investors
Chefs and culinary professionals
Tourism operators
Hospitality businesses
Food producers and farmers
Development partners and industry stakeholders
Personal Branding for Culinary Professionals

13:00 – 14:00 | Lunch
14:00 – 16:00 | City Tour (3 Dikgosi, Museum, Orapa house, Mmankgodit.)

DAY 2: PAN-AFRICAN GASTRONOMY CONFERENCE, INNOVATION & SKILLS DEVELOPMENT

08:30 – 09:15 | Panel Discussion: Culinary Tourism – Positioning Botswana as a Destination
09:15 – 10:00 | Indigenous Foods and Products – Presentation
10:00 – 10:30 | Country Cuisine Showcase
10:30 – 11:00 | Tea Break
11:00 – 13:00 | Masterclass Series
African Cuisine Innovation
Food Styling
Personal Branding for Culinary Professionals

13:00 – 14:00 | Lunch
14:00 – 14:45 | Culinary Entrepreneurship - Thematic Panel Discussions

14:45 – 15:30 | Intellectual Property in Gastronomy (Presentation)
15:30 – 16:00 | Refresh
16:00 – 20:30 | Drama

DAY 3 : 10:30 – 11:00 | Tea Break

EXHIBITION & TRADE FAIR - Exhibition & Trade Fair (Open Throughout the Day)
CULINARY COMPETITIONS

08:00 – 10:30 | Young African Chef Challenge

11:00 – 12:30 | Local Inter Hotel Culinary Competition

13:00 – 14:00 | Break / Refreshments

14:00 – 19:00 | BMC Lobatse , Mogobane Dipopolere Plantation

DAY 4 : CULINARY COMPETITIONS & GALA DINNER

AFRICAN GASTRONOMY GALA DINNER & AWARDS CEREMONY

08:00 – 10:30 | African Fusion Culinary Competition

11:00 – 12:30 | Plant based Challenge

13:00 – 14:00 | Break / Refreshments

18:30 – 19:30 | Guest Arrival & Red Carpet Reception

19:30 – 19:40 | Opening & Welcome Remarks

19:40 – 20:15 | Keynote Addresses

20:15 – 21:15 | African Gastronomy Gala Dinner

21:15 – 22:00 | Awards & Recognition Ceremony

22:00 – 22:30 | Closing Toast & Networking

15:30 – 16:00 | Refresh

16:00 – 20:30 | Drama



6- EXPECTED OUTCOMES

- Increase visibility of Botswana as a culinary tourism destination, contributing to measurable growth in visitor arrivals and tourism revenue.
- Creation of new employment opportunities across tourism, hospitality, food production, catering, and related value chains.
- Enhanced market access and revenue-generating opportunities for local SMEs, food producers, and culinary entrepreneurs.
- Attraction of domestic and foreign investment into Botswana's tourism, hospitality, agribusiness, and food processing sectors through targeted B2B engagements.
- Strengthened continental culinary partnerships that lead to trade agreements, business collaborations, and cross-border market opportunities.
- Skills transfer for young culinary professionals, improving workforce readiness and employability.
- Increased tourism and hospitality sector collaboration resulting in new products, services, and business ventures.
- Promotion of indigenous foods and sustainable gastronomy as commercially viable products that support local economic development and export potential.



Strategic Area	Indicator	Target
	Total participants	1000
Continental Participation	Countries represented	20
Tourism Impact	Hotel room nights generated	500+
Tourism Impact	Visitor spending generated	P2million+
Business Development	Exhibitors and SMEs participating	50
Investment & Trade	B2B meetings facilitated	50+
Investment & Trade	Partnership agreements /MOUs initiated	15
Skills Development	Students and young professionals engaged	250
Entrepreneurship	Youth and women-owned businesses participating	40
Employment	Temporary jobs created during the event	100+
Employment	Internships and employment opportunities facilitated	50+
Culinary Promotion	Indigenous Botswana dishes showcased	30
Media Visibility	Media and digital reach	N500,000+
Economic Impact	Direct economic activity generated	P5 million+

7- Monitoring and Evaluation

Indicator	Measurement
Attendance	Registration data
Economic impact	Visitor and exhibitor surveys
Media reach	Media monitoring reports
Tourism impact	Hotel occupancy and visitor data
SME participation	Business registration and sales
Sponsor ROI	Brand visibility and engagement analytics

8- Proposed Budget

Item	Budget
International Travel Support (selected delegates)	250,000
Accommodation	180,000
Catering	200,000
Gala Dinner	300,000
Venue Hire & Conference Facilities	300,000
Culinary Competitions & Masterclasses	200,000

Production, Sound & Stage	300,000
Marketing, Media & Public Relations	250,000
Local Transport & Logistics	150,000
Security & Protocol	60,000
Branding, Signage	200,000
Merchandise , uniform, chef jackets, tshirts..	150,000
Administration & Secretariat	409,500
Contingency	150,000
TOTAL	P3,139,0500



9- SPONSORSHIP OPPORTUNITIES

DIAMOND PARTNER

P750,000+

- Exclusive naming rights: “FIGA Botswana 2026 Presented by [Sponsor]”
- Exclusive Diamond Partner status.
- Premium logo placement on all event branding, promotional materials, media campaigns, official publications and social media platforms.
- Exclusive branding of the Main Stage, Opening Ceremony and Gala Dinner.
- Branding on official chef jackets, delegate lanyards, accreditation badges and selected event merchandise.
- Opportunity to deliver keynote remarks during the Official Opening Ceremony.
- Opportunity to present prestigious competition awards.
- Premium exhibition in a prime location.
- Twenty (20) VIP delegate passes throughout the week.
- 1 VIP table at the African Gastronomy Gala Dinner.
- Participation in media interviews, press conferences and promotional campaigns.
- Recognition in the official event documentary and post-event report.
- Exclusive networking opportunities with government leaders, investors, tourism executives and international delegates.

PLATINUM PARTNER

P250,000+

- Prominent logo placement across all event branding and marketing materials.
- Branding on the official website and digital platforms.
- Speaking opportunity during a conference session or panel discussion.
- Premium 6m × 3m exhibition stand.
- VIP Gala Dinner table for ten (5) guests.
- Ten (10) complimentary delegate passes.

- Recognition during the Opening and Closing Ceremonies.
- Participation in media engagements and official press releases.
- Access to exclusive business networking sessions and B2B meetings.
- First right of renewal for the next edition of FIGA Botswana.

GOLD PARTNER

P150,000+

- Logo placement on event branding, publications and digital platforms.
- Exhibition stand in the trade fair.
- Six (6) complimentary delegate passes.
- (2) VIP invitations to the Opening Ceremony and Gala Dinner.
- Brand recognition during official proceedings.
- Social media promotion before and during the event.
- Opportunity to provide branded promotional items in delegate packs.

SILVER PARTNER

P75,000+

- Logo displayed on the official event website and sponsor boards.
- Exhibition stand allocation.
- Four (4) complimentary delegate passes.
- Recognition on social media and on the official programme.
- Inclusion in sponsor appreciation and acknowledgement activities.

BRONZE PARTNER

P25,000+

- Logo displayed on the official sponsor recognition board.
- Recognition on the event website.
- Two (2) complimentary delegate passes.
- Inclusion in sponsor acknowledgement during the event.
- Opportunity to participate in networking activities

EXHIBITION PARTNERS

P10,000+

- Prime exhibition location.
- 3m × 3m branded exhibition space.
- Four (4) exhibitor passes.
- Company profile in the official event programme.
- Digital recognition on the event website

Standard Exhibition

P5,000+

- 3m × 3m exhibition space.
- Two (2) exhibitor passes.
- Company listing in the official event programme.
- Opportunity to engage directly with delegates, buyers and investors.



10- STRATEGIC PARTNERS

Strategic Tourism & Destination Partners

- Botswana Tourism Organisation (BTO)
- Air Botswana
- Wilderness Safaris
- Roots & Journeys
- Ministry of Youth and Gender Affairs
- Ministry of Tourism
- Hospitality and Tourism Association of Botswana

Strategic Economic Diversification Partners

- Debswana
- Lucara Botswana
- Botswana Investment and Trade Centre (BITC)

Strategic Agrifood & Culinary Partners

- Botswana Meat Commission (BMC)
- Senn Foods
- Choppies Group
- Sefalana Group
- Safari Distributors
- Botswana Agricultural Marketing Board

Strategic Financial & Innovation Partners

- FNB Botswana
- Absa Botswana
- Stanbic Bank Botswana
- Orange Botswana
- Mascom Wireless
- Letshego
- CEDA

A- Chefs from Africa Gastronomie Botswana

CHEF MONANA MOTSWALEDI

Is a renowned chef and entrepreneur from Botswana, recognized for her commitment to culinary education and the development of African gastronomy. An influential businesswoman, she is the president of the Africa Gastronomie Botswana association, through which she actively promotes local and continental culinary heritage.

She is also the founder and managing director of the Gaborone College of Culinary Art (GCCA), an institution dedicated to training chefs and hospitality professionals. Co-founder of African Chef Mentors, she works to support and mentor young African culinary talent, contributing to the emergence of a new generation of skilled and ambitious chefs



B- Founder for the Africa Organisation Gastronomie

CHEF JOSEPH LANCMA

Is a Cameroonian chef recognized for his major role in the large-scale development of African gastronomy. Founder of the Africa Gastronomic Organization, now present in 35 African countries, he actively works to structure and promote culinary professions on the continent.

A culinary coach and hospitality consultant, he specializes in the installation and commissioning of professional kitchens and the training of Food & Beverage teams. Through his expertise and commitment, he contributes to raising the standards of African cuisine and training a new generation of qualified professionals.



Cameroon



C- some Chefs from other African countries

CHEF LOPEZ AHLIGO

Is a hospitality and restaurant professional, an entrepreneur of Togolese and American nationality. After several years of experience in the United States, he returned to Togo with the desire to pass on his know-how and expertise to African youth. A recognized artist in fruit and vegetable carving, he combines culinary creativity with a passion for training.

Vice-President of Africa Gastronomie Togo, he is currently a hospitality consultant, owner and Executive Chef of Talier À Volonté and the recycling and placement agency EHR Sarl. Through his various initiatives, he actively contributes to the development of the gastronomy and hospitality industries in Africa.



Togo



USA



CHEF RODRIGUE SOUROU AGBO

Is a master pastry chef renowned for his excellence and remarkable career in the world of gastronomy. Secretary General of the Africa Gastronomique Burkina Faso association, he actively contributes to the promotion of African culinary expertise. Awarded five world gold medals in desserts, he has established himself as an international pastry authority. An international culinary judge and distinguished on several national and international stages, he embodies high standards, creativity, and the transmission of gastronomic excellence.



Burkina Faso



CHEF SHEILA AHABWE

Is a Ugandan chef and culinary entrepreneur, a leading figure in East African gastronomy. President of Africa Gastronomique Uganda and Vice-President of the Ugandan Chefs Association, she plays a key role in promoting and elevating Ugandan cuisine on the international stage. Regularly representing her country at various culinary events around the world, she showcases authentic, modern, and ambitious African cuisine. She is also the Managing Director and owner of Vine Culinary & Hospitality School and the catering service Vine Kitchen, through which she trains and mentors future professionals in the culinary and hospitality industries. Through her leadership and commitment, she actively contributes to the development and professionalization of the gastronomic sector in Uganda.



Uganda



CHEF FELIX NORMAN

Is a Togolese and American chef with over 22 years of experience in French, American, and African fusion cuisine. President of Africa Gastronomique Diaspora-Américaine, he works to promote African gastronomy internationally. He is also Executive Chef at ATG Management, a group managing over twenty establishments in the United States, where he is distinguished by his culinary expertise and creativity.



Togo



USA



CHEF WINFRED KWADWO SIAW

Is a Ghanaian chef and culinary entrepreneur committed to the promotion and development of African gastronomy. President of Africa Gastronomique Ghana, he actively works to enhance Ghana's culinary heritage and its international profile. Executive Chef and owner of Taste One Catering, he is distinguished by his sense of excellence, creativity, and leadership in the catering industry. Through his activities, he contributes to the professionalization of gastronomy and the showcasing of authentic Ghanaian flavors.



CHEF FAUSTINA SOPRIALA-PEPPLE

Is the Vice President of Africa Gastronomique Nigeria and a recognized expert in cuisine, hospitality, and food safety. A certified professional chef, event planner, and culinary trainer, she is distinguished by her commitment to passing on culinary know-how and supporting entrepreneurs in the food sector.

Founder of Sofausty Foods and Culinary Academy Ltd, she works to empower youth and professionals through hands-on culinary training, promoting food safety standards, and developing sustainable and profitable culinary businesses.



Nigeria



CHEF RAPHAËL NANG MEVOUNG

Is a Gabonese professional chef with over 16 years of experience in gastronomy, training, and culinary coaching. A gourmet chef and event caterer he is renowned for his high-end services at private and professional receptions in Gabon.

President of Africa Gastronomique Gabon, Through his cuisine, he reinterprets traditional Gabonese flavors with creativity and modernity.

He also manages AKIBA NZAME FOOD Catering Restaurant, a company specializing in event planning and gastronomy



Gabon



CHEF RICHARD PEREZ KOMBO

Chef Richard Perez Kombo is a passionate culinary artisan, nutrition and restaurant consultant, renowned for his commitment to promoting African gastronomy. President of the Africa Gastronomique Congo Brazzaville Association, he actively works to promote Congolese and African culinary heritage. Head chef at the Olympic Palace Hotel, he is distinguished by his expertise, rigor, and dedication to a cuisine that combines tradition, nutritional balance, and creativity



Congo brazzaville



CHEF BIENVENU MAHUTONDJI DANSI

Chef Bienvenue Mahutondji Dansi est un chef béninois passionné, actuellement Project Manager d'Africa Gastronomique Bénin. Formé dans des établissements de renom, il a su développer une cuisine qui allie les richesses des saveurs locales aux influences culinaires internationales. Chef cuisinier et formateur en technologie culinaire, restauration et HCCP, il se distingue par son exigence, son sens du détail et son engagement pour la transmission du savoir-faire gastronomique. À travers son parcours, il contribue activement à la valorisation et au rayonnement de l'art culinaire béninois et africain.



Bénin



Conclusion

FIGA Botswana 2026 is more than an event it is a strategic platform for economic transformation, tourism growth, cultural diplomacy, and skills development. By bringing together government, industry, investors, chefs, entrepreneurs, and development partners, the forum will position Botswana as Africa's premier destination where gastronomy, tourism, culture, and business converge. Through this collaborative effort, FIGA Botswana 2026 will leave a legacy of strengthened partnerships, empowered entrepreneurs, enhanced destination competitiveness, and sustainable economic opportunities for communities across Botswana.





CHEF MONANA MOTSWALEDI
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